Forsyth County News

Your "Hometown Paper" Since 1908

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*01 F006130 03/23/98
GO DAWGS!!!
NEWSPAPER GEORGIA
* UNIVERSITY OF GEORGIA

ATHENS GA 30602



Showers, thunderstorms likely with temperatures in high 70s; low 60s.

THIS ISSUE

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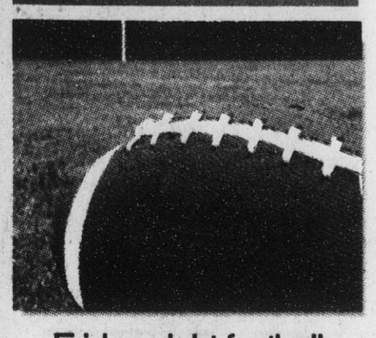
Forsyth Life



Take a walk on the haunted trail.

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Sports



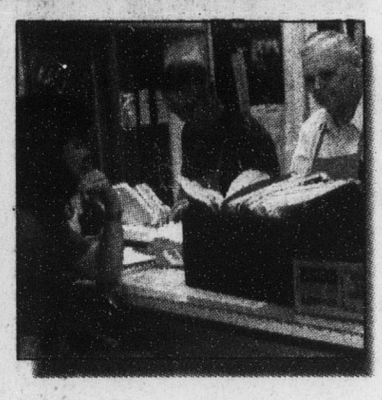
Friday night football: County trio goes for wins

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LAKE LANIER LEVELS

Date	Level
Oct. 21	1065.36 ft
Oct. 22	1065.19 ft
Oct. 23	1065.02 ft
Oct. 24	1064.88 ft
Normal	1071.00 ft

HOME SECTION



Home Improvement II.

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COMING WEDNESDAY

COMMENTARY GALORE

Read Walker Bramblett, Bill Shipp and Phil Danner in Wednesday edition.

Missed paper policy:
For a replacement paper, call 8 a.m. to 6 p.m. Wednesday and Friday, and 9 a.m. to 1 p.m. on Sunday – **887-3126.**

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Missing 11-year-old boy found dead

By Michael Kurtz
Staff Writer

The search for a missing North Forsyth Middle School boy came to a sad end on Thursday when the body of 11-year-old Levi Frady was found in Dawson Forest near an abandoned Lockheed plant.

Friends and neighbors started looking for the boy Thursday morning after his mother, Marilyn Parkman, reported him missing to Forsyth County authorities.

According to Sheriff's Office reports, Frady left his Burruss Mill Road home Wednesday afternoon to do homework at the Noah Road home of a friend. He was expected back by 6:30 p.m.

Parkman went to the Noah Road home around 7:30 p.m. when Frady had not returned.

The friend's parents told her Frady had left on his bicycle to eat dinner at another neighbor's house. No one was home at that address when Parkman stopped by.

She told Sheriff's Office investigators she fell asleep after going home, but Frady had not returned when she woke up around 2 a.m. She said she thought he spent the night at another friend's house.



Frady

Friends and neighbors started searching for Frady on Thursday morning.

Frady's twin sister, Laci, found her brother's bicycle in a ditch off Little Mill Road, about a half mile from his house. There was no sign of her brother.

Investigators from the Sheriff's Office, the Georgia State Patrol, the Georgia Emergency Management Agency and Forsyth County EMS and firefighters were called in to help look for the boy Thursday, but were forced to stop looking at dark.

The same day, three hunters from Gilmer County found the body of a young boy in Dawson Forest. On Friday, the body was identified as Frady.

According to Dawson County Sheriff Billy Carlisle, the boy had been shot.

Investigators are questioning family and friends about Frady's disappearance.

See *BOY*, Page 2A

GBI, Dawson County investigating murder

By Beth L. Chester
Staff Writer

The death of a young Forsyth County sixth grader was no accident. Officials now confirm someone shot the 11-year-old boy and left him to die in a Dawson County forest.

Although Levi Frady was presumably abducted in Forsyth County – probably near the spot where his bicycle was found, authorities say he was murdered a few miles across the line in Dawson County.

"It all happened here," said Dawson County Sheriff Billy Carlisle Friday afternoon, eliminating speculation that the wooded area off Ga. Hwy. 9 might only have been the murderer's dumping ground.

When the boy's assailant is found, Carlisle said, "he or she will he prosecuted here."

A state crime lab autopsy has confirmed that the young boy died as a result of one or more gunshot wounds, but Carlisle said details of autopsy findings – such as the caliber of the weapon used and the location of the wounds – are not yet available.

He would not confirm whether a possible murder weapon has been found or whether a suspect has been identified, but the sheriff did say no warrants have been issued.

Although Carlisle said agents with the Georgia Bureau of Investigation and Forsyth and Dawson County Sheriff's Departments have interviewed numerous potential witnesses in the case, he said authorities so far have not felt it necessary to advise anyone

See *MURDER*, Page 2A



Photo/Tom Brooks

Forsyth County authorities searched for the missing child, whose body was found by hunters in Dawson County, more than 15 miles from where his bicycle was found by his twin sister.



Photo/Tom Brooks

Julian Bowen listens to defense team's discussion while awaiting the jury's return.

Commissioner Bowen is found not guilty by jury

By Michael Kurtz
Staff Writer

Commission chairman Julian Bowen can preside over Monday's board meeting for the first time in five months.

On Friday, Bowen was found not guilty on two counts he lied to obtain special permits on a house he built in 1994.

Bowen had been suspended by Gov. Zell Miller until the case against him was resolved. According to Walker Bramblett, one of Bowen's counsels, the suspension was automatically lifted when the acquittal was handed down.

A tearful Bowen said he was nothing more than the victim of dirty politics.

"I've been through six months of the biggest smear campaign in the history of Georgia politics," he said. "If I hadn't been elected to the county commission, none of this ever would have happened."

Later on Friday, Bowen said he wanted to thank the judge and the jury for taking a week out of their lives to resolve his case.

During closing arguments, defense attorney Ed Tolley said the case was political persecution. Tolley asked jurors if it is right to hold a man responsible for mistakes by a government office, saying someone needs to take a look at the Planning and Zoning Department.

"Is he being prosecuted because it's a crime, or because there have been 12 years of mistakes that need to be corrected?" he

See *NOT GUILTY*, Page 2A

Lake Lanier: Present, future water needs

By Sheri Toomey
Staff Writer

The results of the two-year Lake Lanier modeling study is soon to be released.

The Upper Chattahoochee Basin Group (UCBG) was created in 1993 to conduct the study with the mission "to protect the future water quality of Lake Lanier while meeting present and future water needs."

The state Environmental Protection Division advised surrounding counties in the Upper Chattahoochee River basin to conduct a water quality study of Lake Lanier.

"This study came about as a result of requests by local governments around Lake Lanier to be able to discharge more treated wastewater into the lake than was going in to it now," said EPD director Harold Reheis.

Reheis required EPD involvement when developing the study to ensure scientific validity and usefulness since the state agency will make the final decision on whether permits will be issued for additional wastewater discharge into the lake.

The UCBG steering committee consists of representatives from Forsyth, Gwinnett and Hall counties, the city of Gainesville and the Lake Lanier Association. Forsyth County contributed $200,000, Hall County contributed $100,000 and Gwinnett County funded the remaining amount for the $1.7 - million study.

Since March 1996, Brown and Caldwell Consultants of Atlanta have taken water samples from 28 sites on Lake Lanier and its tributaries, including the Chattahoochee and Chestatee rivers.

Limno-Tech Inc., of Ann Arbor, Mich., used the collected data to create a computer model to simulate conditions on the lake. The model will be used to predict how land use changes will affect the lake water quality in the future.

The Upper Chattahoochee Riverkeeper, the Georgia Farm Bureau Federation, the Lake Lanier Association and other concerned groups form the citizens review committee.

Development rate, land management, pollution points and sewer systems were selected as the most deterministic factors regarding the lake's future.

"One of the key issues is what will hap-

See *LANIER*, Page 10A

Lanier association, Gwinnett officials will meet Oct. 28

By Sheri Toomey
Staff Writer

The Lake Lanier Association has requested a meeting with the Gwinnett County Water and Sewer Department Tuesday regarding questions about the erection of concrete power poles in a residential area.

There is some speculation as to why Buford Dam Road at Lanier Park is being realigned, according to the LLA.

Gwinnett County could be applying for two wastewater discharges into Lake Lanier pending the results of the water quality study, according to a draft release by Limno-Tech Inc., the firm preparing the computer model.

One of the proposed discharge points is near Lanier Park where the industrial use poles are being installed.

See *MEET*, Page 10A

Change your clock, change your battery

The daylight-saving clock change – reset your clock before retiring Saturday night – is the best time to change batteries in your household's smoke detectors.

Take time to take precautions for your family's safety.

